Srijith Poosarla

Carnatic Mandolin Artist

Srijith Poosarla has graduated with a Bachelor of Science (Honours) in Biology and a minor in Psychology from Ashoka University, Sonipat. Srijith has been identified as a child with special talent in Music from a very early age. At a very tender age, Srijith's grandmother, Mrs P. Rathna Raju, Diploma in Veena from the renowned DWARAM NARSINGARAO MEMORIAL MUSIC COLLEGE, Viziyanagaram, who had learnt music under the guidance of Guru CHEMBOLU VENKATASHASTRI and EVATURI VIJAYESHWARRAO, had identified the talent in Srijith.

Srijith began his journey in Carnatic music at the tender age of 6. After more than four years of vocal training, he started learning Mandolin under the guidance of **Guru R. Balakrishna** (disciple of Mandolin U.P. Raju) in 2014, while continuing his vocal studies with **Mrs Niveditha Bharath** (Exponent of Kalakshetra Academy). Over the years, Srijith has blossomed into a fine Mandolin artist, shaped by the mentorship of his gurus and the encouragement of his grandmother.

For the last three years, Srijith has also been under the tutelage of renowned Mandolin **Vidwan U. Rajesh**, **brother of Vidwan U. Srinivas**, further enriching his musicianship and artistry.

Srijith's growth as a fine artist can be witnessed through his Mandolin journey. Srijith has given various performances and curated a lot of independent productions or pieces.

Carnatic music festivals and Kutcheries

1. Muthuswami Dikshithar Day Celebrations – The Indian Fine Arts Society
   4th October 2026, Ethiraja Kalyana Nilayam, Alwarpet, Chennai
   Organized by The Indian Fine Arts Society as part of their Annual Music Competition Prize Distribution & Muthuswami Dikshithar Day Celebrations, Srijith presented a dedicated Carnatic mandolin concert featuring exclusively the compositions of Sri Muthuswami Dikshithar in a traditional instrumental ensemble setting with violin, mridangam, and kanjira. Anchored by the main composition Shree Kanthimathim, the performance showcased the depth, grandeur, and intricate gamakas of Dikshithar's kritis through the electric mandolin within a classic sabha environment
2. BRICS Foreign Ministers' Summit – Tal Fry Ensemble
   14th May 2026, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
   By special request of the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) and the Ministry of External Affairs, Srijith performed as a guest mandolinist with the world-renowned contemporary Indian classical percussion ensemble, "Tal Fry." Performing for the BRICS Foreign Ministers' Summit, Srijith presented a specially arranged Abhang medley. The performance, held at the prestigious Bharat Mandapam, will showcase the mandolin within a high-profile diplomatic and cultural context, representing the synergy between traditional Indian devotional music and contemporary global classical arrangements.
3. Sangamam 2026: Tala Vadya Kacheri 'NADALAYA'
   10th May 2026, Amaltas Hall, India Habitat Centre, New Delhi
   Srijith performed as a featured mandolinist in the 'NADALAYA' Tala Vadya Kacheri at Amaltas Hall, India Habitat Centre, as part of the Sangamam 2026 Festival. Conducted by the renowned Vainika Saraswathi Rajagopalan and supported by the Ministry of Culture,

the performance was a high-level exploration of rare Carnatic compositions. Led by Manohar Balatchandirane on mridangam, Srijith collaborated with world-class artists Ishan Sharma (tabla), Varun Rajasekharan (ghatam), and Sree Rag (vocals). In this rhythm-centric ensemble, Srijith engaged in intricate melodic dialogues, contributing to a sophisticated presentation of traditional structures in one of New Delhi's premier cultural venues.

4. Paddhati Festival 2026
   11th January 2026, Desika Vidhya Bhavanam, Mylapore, Chennai
   Srijith performed a 75-minute Carnatic mandolin concert at the esteemed Paddhati Festival, organised in collaboration with Sri Parthasarathy Swami Sabha and Carnatica. Accompanied by Shreeya Ananth on the violin and Nagore R. Aravind Srikanth on the mridangam, the performance was anchored by a detailed rendition of the kriti "Aadamodi Galadhe" in Raagam Charukeshi. Performing on this prestigious stage during the music season, Srijith demonstrated high technical proficiency and adherence to traditional paddhati (lineage) while showcasing the versatility of the mandolin in a classical ensemble.

5. Dhwani - A Carnatic Mandolin Experience
   4th January 2026, Ashiana Shubham retirement community, Chennai
   Srijith presented a two-hour Carnatic classical concert titled "Dhwani," specifically curated to explore intricate musical concepts such as Sruthibhedam alongside traditional repertoire. Accompanied by Kishore Lakshmanan on the mridangam, the performance featured a selection of famous kritis, blending technical exploration with accessible classical melodies for the resident community. The extended format allowed for a deep dive into the theoretical nuances of the raga systems, showcasing Srijith's ability to balance academic musicality with engaging performance.
6. Indian Fine Arts Society
   26th December 2025, Ethiraj Kalyana Nilayam, Chennai
   Srijith performed a classical Carnatic mandolin kutchery as part of the prestigious Margazhi music season, marking his debut performance in this storied festival circuit. Accompanied by **B. J. Srinivas** on the mridangam and **Anandha Maharaj** on the ghatam, the one-hour concert was highlighted by a soul-stirring rendition of the kriti "Siva Siva Siva Enaraadha" in Raagam Pantuvarali. The performance received significant acclaim from the seasoned Chennai audience for its technical precision and emotive depth, successfully translating the complexities of the composition onto the electric mandolin.
7. Upstairs With Us Baithak Performance
   24th October 2025, Delhi
   Srijith performed a purely classical Carnatic mandolin set at "Upstairs With Us," an intimate baithak space in Delhi. The performance was characterised by a dynamic rhythmic dialogue between Srijith and two percussionists: Arjun Aravindd on the mridangam and Sri Ram on the ghatam and kanjira. This collaborative session emphasised the improvisational interplay between the mandolin and the percussive ensemble, showcasing technical mastery and the traditional Laya aspects of Carnatic music in a close-knit, salon-style setting.
8. Ayataara Baithak Performance
   11th October 2025, Ayataara, Bangalore
   Srijith performed an intimate Carnatic mandolin set at Ayataara, a dedicated baithak space in Bangalore. Accompanied by Anghiras on the mridangam, the performance focused on a calm and emotive exploration of classical ragas, tailored for the close-knit, traditional baithak setting. The concert emphasised the nuanced, meditative aspects of the mandolin, fostering a deep connection between the performers and the audience through a repertoire centred on bhava and expressive detail.
9. Inauguration Ceremony of the Hungry Caterpillar
   25th September 2025, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Srijith performed a Carnatic classical set for the formal outdoor inauguration of the "Hungry Caterpillar" architectural structure and campus venue. Collaborating with a vocalist and a tabla

player, he transitioned traditional classical structures into an open-air architectural setting, providing the inaugural musical atmosphere for the new campus landmark.

10. EMBO Sleep Conference
    11th March 2025, Gulmohar Auditorium, India Habitat Centre, New Delhi
    Srijith curated and led the closing performance for the first day of the EMBO Sleep Conference, collaborating with Carnatic and Hindustani vocalists, guitar, bass, and tabla. The concert featured both Carnatic and Hindustani classical music, offering a cross-genre musical experience to an internationally renowned scientific audience.
11. BraiNDy Cognitive Neuroscience Conference
    14th December 2024, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
    Srijith curated and performed an intimate Carnatic concert as the closing act for the two-day BraiNDy Neuroscience Conference. Attended by renowned scientists from around the world, the performance offered a unique cultural experience, blending classical music with the academic atmosphere of the international event.
12. Selayur Sangeet Natya Utsav
    26th December 2020, Selayur, Chennai
    Performed Carnatic mandolin at the annual Selayur Sangeet Natya Utsav, organised by the Suryalakshmi Foundation. The performance featured traditional Carnatic compositions in a classical kutchery format.
13. Performed at the renowned **Sri Kapaleeswarar temple** in January 2019 as part of the annual music festival and had rave reviews from the audience
14. Performed at the Hawa Mahal in Visakhapatnam, where various Vizag artists congregated in December 2017
15. Performed at Gaudiya Mutt's annual **Krishna Jayanthi celebrations** as the star artist from 2017 to 2022
16. Performed at Geeta Mandir, Parrys, in July, 2017 on the occasion of **Mahamantra Bhajana Mandali**'s 84th anniversary celebrations
17. Performing as a star artist at the Annual **Annammayya Akandam** for many years, between 2016 and 2022 on the occasion of Vaikunta Ekadasi at Ethiraj Kalyana Mandapam

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Independent Productions and Musical Ventures

1. Srijith and Friends: Small Table Session
   18th April 2026, Ashoka University Music Studio, Sonipat
   Srijith served as the anchor and arranger for a "Small Table" live-recording session, leading a multi-instrumental ensemble through a complex exploration of Carnatic arithmetic, jazz, and progressive fusion. The set featured a diverse repertoire, including traditional Thillanas, lullabies, and contemporary indie covers, reimagined through intricate vocal harmonies and a rich instrumental palette of kazoo, bass, guitar, keys, and drums. This curated production showcased Srijith's ability to orchestrate multi-genre arrangements while maintaining a cohesive dialogue between classical Indian structures and modern progressive music.
2. Battle of Bands: Ashoka University
   2nd April 2026, Amphitheatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Srijith's band, Half Ka Double, secured a decisive first-place victory at Ashoka University's annual Battle of the Bands competition. As the lead mandolinist, Srijith spearheaded a high-energy set that blended Bollywood and Tamil hits with sophisticated fusion arrangements. A centrepiece of the performance was his technically rigorous and emotive solo in *Raagam Punnagavarali*, which

contributed to the band winning by a high margin and further establishing their reputation as a premier contemporary fusion ensemble on campus.

3. Unlectured - Arts Room
   22nd February 2026, Arts Room, Eldeco Centre, New Delhi
   Srijith performed a classical solo mandolin set as the opening act for a lecture exploring the intersection of music and neuroscience. The performance centred on a detailed Raagam Thanam Pallavi, demonstrating the structural complexities of Carnatic music to an audience of academics and art enthusiasts. By presenting this traditional format in a contemporary lecture setting, Srijith highlighted the cognitive and mathematical depth of the Manodharma (improvisational) aspects of the mandolin.
4. Unlectured – Siyah Arthouse
   30th January 2026, Siyah Arthouse, Delhi
   Srijith curated and performed a contemporary opening set for "Unlectured," a featured talk by Professor Arunava Sinha on the art of translation. Leading an ensemble featuring vocals, bass, and drums, he presented a neo-soul and jazz-fusion exploration of Carnatic music. In addition to his role as the lead mandolinist, Srijith served as the sound manager for the production, ensuring the technical execution of the multi-genre performance in an intimate arthouse setting.
5. Small Table Session: Shivom (Drummer)
   26th January 2026, Ashoka University Music Studio, Sonipat
   Srijith collaborated as a featured mandolinist for a "Small Table" session, a student-led live recording venture at Ashoka University inspired by the Tiny Desk format. Performing alongside drummer Shivom, the set featured an eclectic blend of indie fusion, Indian jazz, and contemporary funk. The session, recorded in a professional studio environment for a forthcoming YouTube release, showcased the mandolin's versatility in a modern, percussion-driven ensemble, bridging Indian classical nuances with global groove-based genres.
6. Thursday Night Live (TNL)
   30th October 2025, Black Box Theatre, Sonipat
   Srijith's band, Half Ka Double, performed as the opening act for "Thursday Night Live," Ashoka University's flagship music event. As the lead mandolinist and sound production head, he led the ensemble through a high-energy set of Indian fusion, prog-rock, and jazz. The performance served as a major platform for the band's genre-bending sound, reaching a wide campus audience and solidifying their presence in the university's contemporary music scene.
7. Pupcert – Fundraiser for Indie Stray Dogs
   25th September 2025, Dr Reddy's Auditorium, Sonipat
   Srijith served as the lead mandolin player, sound engineer, and sound production head for a high-energy fundraiser performance with his band, Half Ka Double. The event, titled "Pupcert," featured a diverse set blending Indian fusion, funk, progressive rock, jazz, Bollywood, and indie genres for an audience of 400 people. The performance successfully raised ₹51,000 for the welfare of local indie stray dogs, demonstrating Srijith's dual expertise in technical sound production and live performance for social impact.
8. Creative Writing Thesis Performance
   25th April 2025, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Srijith performed Carnatic mandolin in collaboration with spoken word poetry for a friend's creative writing thesis. This innovative, first-of-its-kind event at Ashoka University featured an interactive blend of classical music and live poetry, showcasing new possibilities for interdisciplinary artistic expression.
9. Battle of Bands
   28th March 2025, Amphitheatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Performed at Ashoka University's annual Battle of the Bands competition, presenting a unique Carnatic fusion set. Srijith blended elements of progressive rock, Gujarati folk, and Tamil folk, showcasing innovative cross-genre collaboration and expanding the musical diversity of the campus event.
10. Strange Station

24th October 2024, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
Curated and led by Srijith with two collaborators, Strange Station was Ashoka University's first music-only production. The show explored fusion across genres– Carnatic, progressive rock, neo-soul, Western classical, Indian film music, and jazz; earning high acclaim on campus for its innovative programming and genre-blending performances.

11. Agar
1st and 2nd April 2024, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
Performed in a production exploring the fusion of Kathak dance with Hindustani and Carnatic musical styles. He played Carnatic mandolin alongside tabla, sitar, violin, and vocals, integrating Kathak concepts of *nritya*, *abhinaya*, and *padhant*, creating a rich dialogue between Carnatic music and classical dance.
12. AshokaRasa
December 2023 & February 2024, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
Srijith introduced the Carnatic mandolin to Ashoka University through two editions of AshokaRasa. The first, for Founders Day in December 2023, featured mandolin, vocals, and violin for an audience of 200 university founders, marking the debut of Carnatic mandolin at Ashoka. The second, in February 2024, was presented for university heads and leaders, with Srijith collaborating with a Carnatic violinist and tabla player, further establishing the mandolin's presence in Ashoka's classical music scene.
13. Video Album Launch
2022, YouTube
Launched a video album featuring original renditions of famous Carnatic compositions and medleys. Released on YouTube, this marked Srijith's first produced and recorded project, showcasing his skill.
14. Online Charity Concert for Covid Relief
2021, YouTube (Virtual)
Performed a solo Carnatic mandolin concert during the second wave lockdown, livestreamed on YouTube to raise funds for Covid relief. The online fundraiser successfully contributed nearly 1 lakh towards various relief activities during the pandemic.

Musical Ventures through Alankār

Instrumentalist Head 2024-25, Member since January 2023 to May 2026.
Srijith has been part of his university's Indian Classical Choir Alankār since February 2023, and has been the instrumentalist head for the Academic session of 2024. Through Alankār, Srijith has curated and performed as part of various productions and Bi-annual Showcases as follows-

1. Maati
16th March 2026, Black Box Theatre, Sonipat
Srijith performed as a lead instrumentalist in "Maati," an Alankār production dedicated to the diverse folk traditions of India. The music-only showcase featured a curated selection of folk music spanning the country, including Assamese, Malayalam, Tamil, Kannada, Konkani, Marathi, Hindi, and Punjabi traditions. Srijith's mandolin provided the melodic foundation for these regional styles, translating authentic folk textures into a cohesive ensemble performance that celebrated India's rich indigenous musical heritage.
2. Samvād
9th November 2025, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
As the Creative Director, Srijith ideated, curated, and orchestrated Samvād, a large-scale Alankār production that bridged the gap between Western classical vocal arrangements and Indian musical traditions. Leading a massive ensemble of 40 vocalists and 10 instrumentalists, he managed the

complex logistics and headed the sound design for the show. Srijith performed on the electric mandolin, showcasing how Indian classical melodies can be integrated into structured choral harmonies, marking a significant milestone in the university's experimental music scene.

3. Alankār Showcase
   24th April 2025, Dr Reddy's Auditorium, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Srijith's final performance as instrumental head of Alankār, this independently curated, hour-long Bi-annual choir showcase featured five sets spanning a wide array of genres, including rock, folk, jazz, R&B, choral ensemble, Bollywood, Tollywood, Kollywood, Mollywood, instrumental, Carnatic, Hindustani, acid house, and more. The event was highly acclaimed on campus, drawing an audience from across the country.
4. Kalakriti
   20th March 2025, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Srijith's first collaborative production as instrumental head of Alankār, Kalakriti featured five miniature sets exploring the inner world of artists—mistakes, perfection, struggle, admiration, and interpretation. Collaborating with Abhinaya and the Indian classical dance team, the show blended Hindustani and Carnatic music with Kathak, Bharatanatyam, Kuchipudi, and Odissi, earning high acclaim from campus and external visitors.
5. Aarambh - Alankār Showcase
   29th November 2024, Reddy's Auditorium, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Srijith's first event as the instrumental head of Alankār, Aarambh, guided the audience through the journey of war using music. The performance featured Carnatic, Hindustani, and film music, alongside choral and instrumental ensembles, showcasing innovative storytelling and musical direction in a large-scale choir production.
6. Navarasa 2.0
   April & June 2024- IIT Delhi, New Delhi & Black Box Theatre- Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Building on the success of the original Navarasa production, Srijith, through Alankār, brought the emotive range of Indian classical music to new audiences with Navarasa 2.0. The journey began with an invitation to perform a music-only version of the show at IIT Delhi in April 2024, marking Alankār's first external performance in Delhi and receiving acclaim for its innovative exploration of the Navarasas. Following this, Dr Pramath Raj Sinha, founder and trustee at Ashoka, invited the ensemble to professionally record the Navarasa show at Ashoka University's Black Box Theatre in June 2024. This pioneering session, captured in both video and audio, marked the university's first professional ensemble recording, further cementing the production's significance within Ashoka's musical landscape.
7. Coke Studio Showcase
   30th November 2023, Reddy's Auditorium, Sonipat
   Performed as part of Alankār 's bi-annual choir showcase, Srijith helped curate and perform the first themed "Coke Studio Showcase" at Ashoka University. The concert explored indigenous folk music styles from across India alongside Carnatic music, highlighting the country's musical diversity and marking a new creative direction for the choir.
8. Navarasa
   30th and 31st October 2023, Black Box Theatre, Ashoka University, Sonipat
   Performed with Alankār and Abhinaya, the dance society of Ashoka University, in the college's first student-led music production involving Carnatic Music and Bharatanatyam. He contributed to curating and performing in the production, which uniquely depicted the *Navarasas* through music —a rare and innovative approach, earning appreciation for its creativity and collaboration.
9. Alankār Showcase
   25th April 2023, Reddy's Auditorium, Sonipat
   Performed with Alankār, Ashoka University's Indian Choir, at the bi-annual college showcase, blending traditional Indian melodies with contemporary arrangements. This performance highlighted Srijith's versatility and celebrated the vibrant diversity of Indian music within a collaborative and dynamic ensemble setting.
10. Banjaara '23

26th March 2023, Reddy's Auditorium, Sonipat
Performed with the Indian Classical Choir at Ashoka University as the closing act of Banjaara, the university's music festival. This was his first ensemble performance and first time collaborating with tabla and guitar, blending classical and contemporary styles for a memorable festival finale.

Produced Music and Recorded Audio

1. Mayura Alarippu – Studio Production
   3rd February 2026, Studio Production
   Srijith produced and recorded a dedicated track for a Bharatanatyam dance team, titled "Mayura Alarippu." Set in the rhythmic cycle of Mishra Chapu, the production featured a traditional ensemble of tabla, vocals, and nattuvangam, with Srijith's mandolin providing the melodic framework. By managing the full recording and production process, he created a cohesive studio-grade track that balanced the rigid structural requirements of classical dance with the tonal nuances of the electric mandolin.
